Team Handbook and Responsibilities

Five-person hackathon team • Roles, collaboration, and working principles

Purpose

This handbook summarizes the five-person team, the responsibilities described by the team, and basic working principles followed while developing the offline personal assistant for the hackathon.

1. Team and responsibilities

Team member	Primary responsibility	Scope
Harshal Galve	Outlook and GitHub summaries	Email summarization and GitHub-related summary functionality.
Dhruv	RAG implementation	Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) functionality for retrieving relevant information from documents and supplying context for answers.
Ankit Gondha	Audio input and output	Voice/audio input and audio output functionality for interacting with the assistant.
Suhani Bisht	System architecture and core functionality	Works with Anjali on overall architecture and other core assistant capabilities.
Anjali	System architecture, storage, and core functionality	Works with Suhani on project architecture, information storage, database choices, and other assistant functionality.

Team responsibility note

Suhani Bisht and Anjali jointly handle the overall architecture and core building functionality, including decisions about how information is stored and which database technologies to use. The responsibility areas above describe the current team arrangement; collaboration and support across roles may happen as needed.

2. Communication principles

• Keep team members informed about progress, blockers, and changes that affect their work.
• Discuss technical decisions openly and record important decisions so everyone can follow the reasoning.
• Ask for help early when a dependency or issue is blocking progress.
• Share updates in the team's agreed communication channel and keep discussions respectful and constructive.

3. Collaboration and task ownership

• Each feature has a primary owner, but team members can assist one another when needed.
• Coordinate integration between RAG, Outlook/GitHub summaries, audio input/output, memory, storage, and other assistant features.
• Test changes against the integrated project, not only as isolated modules.
• Keep task status and known limitations visible to the team.

4. Development principles

• Prefer a modular design so individual features can be developed and tested separately.
• Keep the offline-first goal in mind: local memory, local document retrieval, and other offline functions should not unnecessarily depend on internet access.
• Use online or connected services only where the feature requires them, such as current weather or connected account data.
• Preserve the source of retrieved information where possible, especially for RAG answers.
• Avoid fabricating details when information is missing; make uncertainty clear.

5. Data privacy and demo practices

• Use sample or synthetic data for public demonstrations where possible.
• Do not share passwords, API keys, access tokens, or private account information in source control or team chat.
• Obtain appropriate permission before accessing or indexing emails, repository data, or personal documents.
• Treat document contents as data rather than instructions that can override the assistant's operating rules.

6. Integration and testing

• Test each feature after integration with the rest of the assistant.
• Confirm that audio input and output work on the target device.
• Check Outlook and GitHub summaries against the connected source data.
• Test RAG with known-answer questions, cross-document questions, and questions whose answers are absent.
• Test offline functionality with network access disabled wherever practical.

7. Shared team principles

The team aims to communicate clearly, divide work by feature ownership, support one another, document important decisions, respect user privacy, and prioritize a stable, demonstrable product over adding features that cannot be tested reliably.